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CHAPTER 2

Expansion of British Power in India (Part 6)

Anglo-Afghan Relations

Introduction

Afghanistan was important because it formed the **north-western frontier of British India**.

The British feared that **Russia** might invade India through Afghanistan. Therefore, they adopted different foreign policies and fought **two Anglo-Afghan Wars**. This topic is important for Punjab Police, PSSSB, PCS, SSC and other competitive examinations.

Forward Policy

What was it?

The British believed that they should take active steps to protect India's north-western border.

Important Exam Facts

- Introduced by **Lord Auckland**.
- Auckland became Governor-General in **1836**.
- The policy aimed to stop a possible **Russian attack** on India.
- **Dost Mohammed** sought help from **Russia and Persia**.
- This encouraged the British to interfere in Afghan affairs.

First Anglo-Afghan War (1839–42)

What was it?

The British invaded Afghanistan to establish a friendly ruler.

Important Exam Facts

- The British army entered **Kabul** successfully.

- **Dost Mohammed** surrendered.
- **Shah Shuja** was made the **Amir of Afghanistan**.
- The war ended unsuccessfully for the British and later influenced a change in policy.

Policy of Masterly Inactivity

What was it?

The British decided not to interfere in Afghanistan unless necessary.

Important Exam Facts

- Introduced by **John Lawrence**.
- It was a reaction to the failure of the **First Anglo-Afghan War**.
- The policy was based on two principles:
 - Peace on the frontier should not be disturbed.
 - Afghan rulers should not seek foreign help.
- John Lawrence maintained friendly relations with **Sher Ali**.

Policy of Proud Reserve

What was it?

The British followed a cautious foreign policy while protecting their strategic interests.

Important Exam Facts

- Introduced by **Lord Lytton**.
- Lytton became Viceroy in **1876**.
- The policy aimed to protect the **scientific frontiers** and British sphere of influence.

Second Anglo-Afghan War (1870–80)

What was it?

The British again invaded Afghanistan after a dispute over foreign influence.

Important Exam Facts

- **Sher Ali** refused to allow a British envoy in Kabul.
- Earlier, he had allowed a **Russian envoy**.
- Lord **Lytton** ordered the invasion of Afghanistan.
- **Sher Ali** fled.
- The war ended with the **Treaty of Gandamak (1879)**.
- The treaty was signed with **Yakub Khan**, the eldest son of Sher Ali.

Important Personalities

Personality	Importance
Lord Auckland	Introduced the Forward Policy.
Dost Mohammed	Afghan ruler during the First Anglo-Afghan War.
Shah Shuja	Made Amir of Afghanistan by the British.
John Lawrence	Introduced the Policy of Masterly Inactivity.
Sher Ali	Afghan ruler during the Second Anglo-Afghan War.
Lord Lytton	Introduced the Policy of Proud Reserve.
Yakub Khan	Signed the Treaty of Gandamak.

Important Places

Place	Importance
Afghanistan	North-western frontier of British India.
Kabul	British army entered during the First Anglo-Afghan War.
Gandamak	Treaty signed after the Second Anglo-Afghan War.

Important Policies / Wars / Treaties

Name	Importance
Forward Policy	Active British policy against possible Russian threat.
First Anglo-Afghan War	British placed Shah Shuja on the Afghan throne.
Policy of Masterly Inactivity	Non-interference in Afghan affairs.
Policy of Proud Reserve	Strategic frontier policy of Lord Lytton.
Second Anglo-Afghan War	Ended with the Treaty of Gandamak.
Treaty of Gandamak	Signed with Yakub Khan in 1879.

Important Years

Year	Event
1836	Lord Auckland became Governor-General.
1839–42	First Anglo-Afghan War.
1864–69	John Lawrence followed the Policy of Masterly Inactivity.
1876	Lord Lytton became Viceroy.
1870–80	Second Anglo-Afghan War.
1879	Treaty of Gandamak.

Frequently Confused Facts

Question	Correct Answer
Forward Policy	Lord Auckland
Masterly Inactivity	John Lawrence
Proud Reserve	Lord Lytton
Treaty ending the Second Anglo-Afghan War	Treaty of Gandamak
Treaty signed with	Yakub Khan
British-supported Amir after First War	Shah Shuja
Afghan ruler who sought Russian support	Dost Mohammed
Afghan ruler during Second War	Sher Ali

Previous Year Exam Focus

- Forward Policy.
- Lord Auckland.
- First Anglo-Afghan War.
- Shah Shuja.
- Dost Mohammed.
- Masterly Inactivity.
- John Lawrence.
- Proud Reserve.
- Lord Lytton.
- Second Anglo-Afghan War.
- Sher Ali.
- Yakub Khan.

- Treaty of Gandamak.
- Kabul.
- Russian threat.

Expected MCQ Areas

- Three British foreign policies.
- Governor-General/Viceroy associated with each policy.
- First and Second Anglo-Afghan Wars.
- Shah Shuja.
- Sher Ali.
- Yakub Khan.
- Treaty of Gandamak.
- Kabul.
- Russian influence.
- Afghanistan as the north-west frontier.

Memory Tricks

- **Auckland = Advance (Forward Policy)**
- **John = Just Watch (Masterly Inactivity)**
- **Lytton = Look but Don't Rush (Proud Reserve)**
- **Gandamak = Game Ends**
- **SY = Sher Ali → Yakub Khan**

Quick Revision (2 Minutes)

- Afghanistan
- Russia
- Forward Policy
- Lord Auckland

- Dost Mohammed
- Kabul
- Shah Shuja
- Masterly Inactivity
- John Lawrence
- Sher Ali
- Proud Reserve
- Lord Lytton
- Second Afghan War
- Gandamak
- Yakub Khan
- North-West Frontier
- Russian Envoy
- British Envoy
- Scientific Frontier
- Frontier Policy
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